

Clean the Boat.

The Squid Ink Principle.

Session 33 · Monday 15 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

IN THIS TOOLKIT

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01 · THE TRUTH ABOUT SELLING

There Is No Silver Bullet

You're a 147-kilowatt engine. You can only make it worse.

SALES IS A FIXED-CEILING ENGINE**CEILING · 147kW****100% CAPACITY — YOU'RE ALREADY HERE****WHAT YOU CAN'T DO**

- ✗ Convince an unwilling buyer
- ✗ Find a magic line that closes everyone
- ✗ Push past 147kW with effort alone

WHAT YOU CAN DO

- ◆ Make it worse — by saying dumb things
- ◆ Blow the engine — by abandoning process
- ◆ Reduce output — by sounding desperate

THE JOB

Be the boringly reliable Toyota. Run the process every time. Don't blow yourself up. Keep moving. That's the whole game — there is no "more" to extract.

02 · THE METAPHOR

The Squid Ink Principle

What buyers' lies actually are — and why it isn't personal.

THE METAPHOR

A squid sprays ink when attacked — not to harm the predator, but to confuse the moment and escape. Cold-called buyers do the same thing.

THE INK · WHAT IT TRANSLATES TO

"I'm not interested."	→ "Please end this call."
"I'm too busy."	→ "I don't know how to evaluate you yet."
"Send me an email."	→ "I want this call to end politely."
"I already have a provider."	→ "I don't want to defend a sunk cost right now."

THE DISCIPLINE

Mentally label every defensive line as INK. Don't argue with ink — that's how the squid wins (the predator gets confused). Respond to what you think might be the real situation, not the literal claim.

REMEMBER · IT'S NOT PERSONAL

The buyer isn't being evil. It's human nature. Save the moral outrage for actual emergencies.

03 · THE PATTERN

Two Opposite Lies

Both are defensive. Both deserve the same response.

THE UNDER-STATEMENT

**"I can't take more work
— flat out booked."**

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

Defensive deflection. Almost no business in history has genuinely turned away a free customer.

DEFAULT ASSUMPTION

Treat as deflection, not fact. Stay calm. Stay on process.

THE OVER-STATEMENT

**"I'll buy SEO for all 10
of my businesses!"**

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

Bait. Using the size of the opportunity to extract concessions, then quietly walk when negotiation tightens.

DEFAULT ASSUMPTION

Treat as bluff. Don't get excited. Stay on process.

THE COUNTER TO THE OVER-STATEMENT · USE VERBATIM

"With all due respect, I'd rather prove myself on one campaign first. Pick the business you most want results for — let's do that one really well, and then talk about the rest."

Loses nothing. If genuine → they start with one. If bluffing → bluff collapses.

04 · MINDSET HYGIENE

Clean the Boat

Hose the ink off between calls — before it dries.

WHY THE BOAT NEEDS CLEANING

30 calls a day. Most of them are ink. Without a deliberate cleaning ritual, the frustration from call 7 leaks into call 8, into call 9, and by call 20 the rep is talking to every buyer as though they've already been lied to.

THE BUYER HEARS IT. THE DAY COLLAPSES.

THE CLEANING RITUALS

AFTER A BAD CALL

Stand up. Walk to the kitchen. Get water. Come back. Physical reset interrupts the mental loop.

MID-MORNING + MID-AFTERNOON

Three-minute walk outside. The brain resets faster than you'd expect — and the air helps.

LOOP IN HEAD

When you're stuck on "I should have said X" — write it down. Capture closes the loop.

MID-DAY VENTING

Save it for end of day. Venting mid-day reinforces frustration. Vent on the way out, not at lunch.

"Hose the boat down. Get the ink off. Don't let day eight of negativity build up on the boat — the value goes down."

05 · THE VERBAL MOVE

The Cheeky Callback

Naming the selective-hearing lie with humour.

THE SETUP

Buyer said yes to "can you take more work?" at the start. Realised they were being sold to. Now they're backtracking — "actually I'm flat out, can't take any."

DON'T LET IT SLIDE. DON'T PUSH HARD. USE HUMOUR.

THE LINE · WITH WARM ENERGY

"Hang on — did I just do that to you? You said you could take more work, now you're backtracking. That's a pretty good pitch I just did. Worth a finder's fee, isn't it?"

THREE THINGS IT DOES AT ONCE

Names the contradiction	without accusing — the buyer doesn't have to defend the lie.
Keeps the tone light	humour disarms what direct accusation would harden.
Gives them a way back in	most buyers laugh, soften, and reopen the conversation.

TONE WARNING

Cold delivery = accusatory. Warm delivery = playful. Practise with a colleague first. Tone is everything.

REFERENCE

Daily Card · Keep By the Phone

The whole session on one page.

THE ENGINE

- ◆ You're a 147kW engine. No silver bullet exists.
- ◆ You can only make it worse — by saying dumb things.
- ◆ Be the boringly reliable Toyota. Run the process.

THE INK

- ◆ "Not interested" / "too busy" = ink, not data.
- ◆ "I'll buy everything" = also ink. Don't get excited.
- ◆ Respond to the real situation, not the literal claim.

THE BOAT

- ◆ Bad call → stand up, water, walk, reset.
- ◆ Mid-morning + mid-afternoon: 3-min walk outside.
- ◆ Loops → write it down. Capture closes the loop.

THE GAME

- ◆ Chase the deal. Never chase the customer.
- ◆ Cheeky callback (with warm energy): name the lie.
- ◆ Quote every meeting at 5 minutes. Never more.

CLEAN MIND. CLEAN BOAT. NEXT CALL.